Some examples for power factors:

(i) Power factor = cos 0° = 1 for a pure resistive circuit because the phase angle ϕ between voltage and current is zero.

(ii) Power factor $= \cos\left(\pm \pi/2\right) = 0$ for a purely inductive or capacitive circuit because the phase angle ϕ between voltage and current is $\pm \pi/2$.

(iii) Power factor lies between 0 and 1 for a circuit having R, L and C in varying proportions.

4.8.4 Advantages and disadvantages of AC over DC

There are many advantages and disadvantages of AC system over DC system.

Advantages:

(i) The generation of AC is cheaper than that of DC.

(ii) When AC is supplied at higher voltages, the transmission losses are small compared to DC transmission.

(iii) AC can easily be converted into DC with the help of rectifiers.

Disadvantages:

(i) Alternating voltages cannot be used for certain applications such as charging of batteries, electroplating, electric traction etc.

(ii) At high voltages, it is more dangerous to work with AC than DC.

EXAMPLE 4.26

A series RLC circuit which resonates at 400 kHz has 80 μH inductor, 2000 pF capacitor and 50 Ω resistor. Calculate (i) Q-factor of the circuit (ii) the new value of capacitance when the value of inductance is doubled and (iii) the new Q-factor.

Solution

$L = 80 \times 10^{-6}$ H; $C = 2000 \times 10^{-12}$ F

$R = 50\ \Omega$; $f_r = 400 \times 10^3$ Hz

(i) Q-factor, $Q_1 = \dfrac{1}{R}\sqrt{\dfrac{L}{C}}$

$$= \frac{1}{50}\sqrt{\frac{80\times10^{-6}}{2000\times10^{-12}}} = 4$$

(ii) When $L_2 = 2\ L$

$= 2 \times 80 \times 10^{-6}$ H

$= 160 \times 10^{-6}$ H,

$$C_2 = \frac{1}{4\pi^2 f_r^2 L_2}$$

$$= \frac{1}{4\times3.14^2\times\left(400\times10^3\right)^2\times160\times10^{-6}}$$

$$\simeq 1000\times10^{-12}\,\text{F}$$

$$C_2 \simeq 1000\,\text{pF}$$

(iii) $Q_2 = \dfrac{1}{R}\sqrt{\dfrac{L_2}{C_2}} = \dfrac{1}{50}\sqrt{\dfrac{160\times10^{-6}}{1000\times10^{-12}}}$

$$= \frac{1}{50}\sqrt{\frac{16\times10^{-5}}{10^{-9}}} = \frac{4\times10^2}{50} = 8$$

EXAMPLE 4.27

A capacitor of capacitance $\dfrac{10^{-4}}{\pi}$ F, an inductor of inductance $\dfrac{2}{\pi}$ H and a resistor of resistance 100 Ω are connected to form a series *RLC* circuit. When an AC supply of 220 V, 50 Hz is applied to the circuit, determine (i) the impedance of the circuit (ii) the peak value of current flowing in the circuit (iii) the power factor of the circuit and (iv) the power factor of the circuit at resonance.

Solution

$L = \dfrac{2}{\pi}$ H; $C = \dfrac{10^{-4}}{\pi}$ F; $R = 100\,\Omega$

$V_{RMS} = 220$ V; $f = 50$ Hz

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